



Department of Economics
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Hiring Committee
Nclusion
Palo Alto, CA

Dear Members of the Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Research Economist position at Nclusion. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics, with strong training in applied microeconomic methods and causal inference.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for trust and returns (consistent with the literature) and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly drawn to Nclusion's mission of expanding access to financial services in underserved markets. Many of the questions Nclusion faces, such as how customers respond to savings incentives, how product design influences usage patterns, or how operational changes affect transaction behavior, require careful causal identification and interpretation of administrative data. For example, evaluating whether a new savings feature increases long term account balances would involve designing experimental or quasi experimental variation, estimating heterogeneous treatment effects, and translating those results into product strategy. My training in structural modeling and applied econometrics prepares me to contribute to this type of research while maintaining high standards of transparency and reproducibility.

I am enthusiastic about relocating to Palo Alto and engaging fully in an in office, cross functional environment. I value collaboration with product, operations, and data teams, and I am motivated by the opportunity to see rigorous research directly inform strategy and market expansion. This role would allow me to extend my research agenda into applied financial inclusion contexts while contributing meaningfully to Nclusion's mission.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this role because:

1. I have deep training in applied microeconomic methods and causal inference using large scale datasets.
2. I am experienced in translating quantitative findings into actionable recommendations for non academic audiences.
3. My research on financial behavior and return heterogeneity aligns naturally with questions of savings, investment, and wealth accumulation in emerging markets.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to Nclusion's research and strategy efforts.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards